

ponents. Say, you're only planning on cooling your CPU, then most cases will do the job for you. However, if you wish to liquid cool your CPU and two graphics cards paired in SLI, then you will need to make provisions for an additional radiator. GPUs generate a lot more heat and having two graphics cards would warrant a second radiator. Then you need to consider all the tubing that will be used in your cooling loop. If there are a lot of overlaps, then your case has to be wide enough to account for the additional space.



Your average liquid cooling loop

Credit - EKWB.com

Your typical liquid cooling setup has one CPU block, one radiator, one reservoir and one pump. Then there's the tubing that connect all of these with each other. The more components you wish to cooler, the more radiators you will have to add to your loop. Either way, the four major components we mentioned take up a lot of space, moreover, some components even need to be oriented in a certain manner to reduce load. Here's how your average custom loop will be like.

Note how the reservoir and the pump are typically placed towards the front of the cabinet and the radiator is at the top. The reservoir needs to be mounted vertically in most cases with the pump being fed from it. Some DIY liquid cooling kits even come with the two combined as a single unit so you don't have to worry about the same. The point to note is that once you do have the hard drives and other components installed, you need space to place all these components. Cases built with liquid cooling in mind allow for the hard drive bays to be removed and have provision to mount your hard drives elsewhere. The image pictured here gives you the option to remove your drive cage. Aside from this particular point, everything else is practically the same as installing an AIO.

Cases that go well with liquid cooling

While experienced folk can make do with any case or even build their own cases, those who're starting off with liquid cooling need a little helping hand. Here are some cases known to be custom-loop friendly.